auditing work to be performed, specifying the procedures to be followed in verification of each item and the financial statements and giving the estimated time required."

4.2.3 Features or Characteristics of an Audit Programme

The features of an audit programme are as follows:

1. It is a set of procedures to be adopted to conduct the audit more efficiently.
2. It is a written scheme designed by the auditor.
3. It is a blue print of the audit work.
4. It facilitates delegation of work, based on the capabilities of audit staff.
5. It acts as evidence in future for the audit work being performed.
6. It specifies the work to be done by the audit staff, the manner and time limit for completion of the work.

4.2.4 Objectives of Audit Programme

The following are the objectives of audit programme:

1. To provide clear instructions to the audit assistants specifying the nature of work to be performed and fixing the time span for completion of each work.
2. To facilitate coordination among various parts of audit work.
3. To ensure uniformity in the performance of audit work and to avoid duplication and repetition of work.
4. To attain a fair allocation of work among the audit team.
5. To fix responsibility and accountability of each audit assistant.
6. To serve as a guide for planning the audit work in future.
7. To serve as evidence in future showing the date of completion of audit work, methods or procedures undertaken, persons involved in completion of audit work etc.

4.2.5 Contents of an Audit Programme

The following are the details of an audit programme:

1. Name of the client.
2. Nature of operations and business of client.
3. Review of system of internal check.
4. Date of commencement of audit work.
5. Duration of audit work.
6. Accounting system followed in client organization.
7. Review the report of the previous auditor.
8. Review the remarks, instructions or objections raised in the previous audit report.
9. Examine the various ledger accounts and subsidiary books.

TYPES OF AUDIT PROGRAMME

1. **General or Fixed Audit Programme:** It refers to an audit programme which contains general guidelines common for all audits.
2. **Specific or Flexible Audit Programme:** It refers to an audit programme designed for certain specific functional areas like purchases, stores, inventory control, production control etc.

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